

38 Indirect questions

Indirect questions are more polite than direct questions. They are very common in formal spoken English, particularly when asking for information.

See also:

Present simple 1 Forming questions 34

Types of verbs 49

38.1 INDIRECT OPEN QUESTIONS

Indirect questions often start with a polite opening phrase. After the question word, the word order in indirect questions is the same as in positive statements.



Indirect questions start with an opening phrase.



Where **is** the station?

Do you know
Could you tell me } where **the station is**?

The verb comes after the subject.

FURTHER EXAMPLES

Do you know how much **the tickets will cost**?



Could you tell me why **you were** late?

Could you tell me what time **the stores close**?

Indirect questions leave out the auxiliary verb "do."



HOW TO FORM

OPENING PHRASE

Do you know

Could you tell me

QUESTION WORD

where

SUBJECT

the station

VERB

is?

A polite opening phrase comes first.